Securing Windows in an Insecure World

Some of what you never wanted to know about securing Windows but were afraid to ask.

What we will cover

- Starting from a secure standpoint.
- Looking for open ports.
- Turning off unnecessary services.
- Fire-walling on the cheap.
- Watching what's going on.

Starting Secure

1. Location
2. Location
3. Location

1. Patching
2. Patching
3. Patching

Update the OS

- Run Windows Update
- http://windowsupdate.microsoft.com/
- Repeat

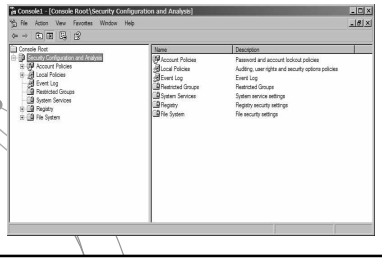
Things that could have been stopped

- Nachi
- Blaster
- Slammer

- several days prior
- one month prior
- six months prior

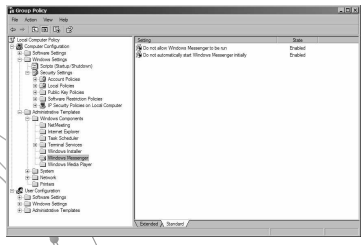
Built in security analysis and lockdown

- HOW TO: Analyze System Security in Windows 2000
- http://support.microsoft.com/default.aspx?scid=kb;en-us;Q313203&sd=tech
- HOW TO: Apply Predefined Security Templates in Windows 2000
- http://support.microsoft.com/default.aspx?scid=kb;en-us;Q309689&sd=tech



Editing Local Policy

- gpedit.msc



Finding the holes that we know about

- Microsoft Baseline Security Analyzer
- http://www.microsoft.com/technet/security/tools/Tools/MBSAhome.asp



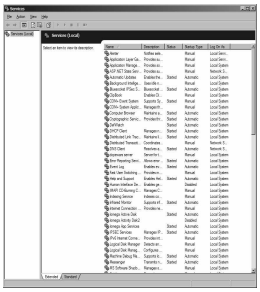
What's exposed?

- nmap, every system administrators friend.
- http://www.insecure.org/nmap/
- What's been exposed to the outside world?
- Are you running what you think you are?
- Are there services on your machine that you don't know about?
- nmap does not like being run against the localhost (127.0.0.1).



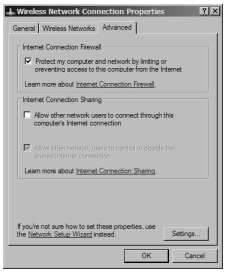
Shut'em down!

- Turn off unnecessary services.
- Telnet
- SMTP
- FTP
- HTTP
- Remote Registry

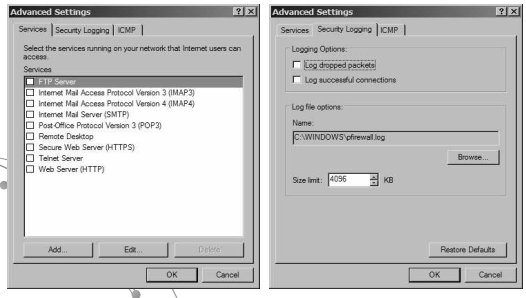


Firewalls on $3/day

- Built in to XP and Windows Server 2003.
- Can be implemented with IPSec policies in Windows 2000.

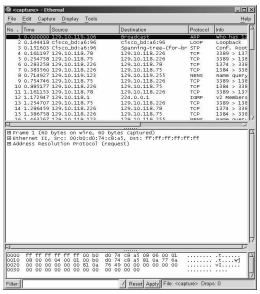


Firewalls on $3/day



Watching what's going on

- http://www.ethereal.com/
- What machines are making connections to this computer?
- What is this computer connecting to?
- What kind of connections are being made?
- What else is happening on the network?



Resources

- http://www.microsoft.com/security/
- http://www.microsoft.com/technet/security/tools/Tools/MBSAhome.asp
- http://support.microsoft.com/default.aspx?scid=kb;en-us;Q313203&sd=tech
- http://support.microsoft.com/default.aspx?scid=kb;en-us;Q309689&sd=tech
- http://www.insecure.org/nmap/
- http://www.ethereal.com/
- http://www.cygwin.com/
- http://security.kolla.de/news.php?lang=en
- http://www.nsa.gov/
- http://www.nsa.gov/snac/index.html
- http://www.sysinternals.com/